Fur is Back

By Eve Ensler

I wanted to be funny. I wanted to be a funny, laughing, invited-to-the-party person. I wanted to be a little flirty, maybe, a little naughty, a little fab, mysterious, chic. I wanted to be fun—telling wild, crazy stories, jumping in the pool naked at midnight, wearing that sexy push-up bra. Driving the convertible fast down the highway in a rainstorm. I wanted to be delicious and adorable and not too available, not too talkative.

I would have settled for a little dry, even, or sarcastic. Dry people get invited to the party. Dry nihilists, who are permanently unhappy, permanently in despair, bleak. They are there in their very expensive torn, shredded black clothing, surrounded by groups of beautiful people with fabulous torn, shredded haircuts that look like they just survived something awful—you know, that private jet ride where they ran out of merlot.

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But I am not dry. I am not adorable. I am not funny. I am angry. ***** angry. I am raging.

INTRODUCTION

I will admit it. Watching the world news makes me angry. So much violence, corruption and so many crimes against humanity that I feel trapped into an anger that has no outlet. Rage that there's nothing I can do to stop or fix any of it.

And I, like many people, turn off the TV, and try to find my way to happiness by ignoring the problems of the world. But I know that this is not the answer. We can't expect to live in our frivolous, self-created bubbles while the world goes to hell. But it seems that more and more, that is the only option left.

Eve Ensler in Fur is Back takes a personal look at how this social "head-in-the-sand" epidemic is played out at a party. When the simple question, "What's up" is answered honestly in light of our world situation, rather than responded to with "Not much, how about you?"

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I do not get invited to parties. Well, not anymore. I did at the beginning. I had a certain charm, a certain flair. People mistook it for funny until they discovered

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that I was the person who ruins the party. Interrupts the pleasure, brings in the rest of the world like a brutal Chicago winter wind. I am the person who, for some reason, has to see it, say it, and make everyone aware. I am the one who responds to the casual "what's up" with "Well, I just got back from Afghanistan, downtown Qandah-ar, where the Taliban is back. Where the Taliban actually never went away, but they are now blatantly back because the U.S. supported the wicked jihadis and put them in office. The jihadis who raped and pillaged and murdered and, instead of being brought to justice, were brought to power by the U.S., and now there is so much corruption and so much violence that the Taliban looks good.

I am that person who doesn't stop there, who has to go on because being at the party makes me even angrier. I somehow forgot until that moment that the rest of the world went on, went to the party, they were laughing, drinking, flirting, enjoying. They weren't undone or depressed by the whacked things going on. No the

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person asking me what's up didn't really expect an answer, didn't even particularly want an answer. Was just asking the question, a stupid party question 'cause that's what people do at parties. They don't listen, they don't give a shit, no, that's why they are at the party. That's why their whole life is a ***** party. Their whole life is directed toward getting invited to the party. Dressing for the party. Getting drunk or into the party mood, and there I am ruining everything. What's up?

What's ***** up? Don't you read the news? The Amish girls shot down in the school 'cause they were there, 'cause they were girls. Or the girls in the refugee camps in Darfur going to get grass for their donkeys or wood for the fire who get grabbed, who get raped and raped and can't find their way back. But let's protect the rapists, okay, let's defend them like the cleric in Australia said. They are being given too hard a time, a terrible sentence, when it's really the woman's fault, she brought it on herself, they brought it on themselves by not wearing a head scarf. They were open meat. If she

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had just stayed in her home, in her hijab, there wouldn't have been a problem. The cleric saying this—in 2006. If they had just stayed at home.

If I had just stayed at home, hadn't gone out, hadn't opened my mouth. I wasn't even invited to this party, a friend was invited and took me 'cause she couldn't find anyone else. It wasn't a direct invitation, a primary invitation from the source to me, and I am ruining the party, embarrassing my friend. I shouldn't have gone out of the house. There were too many bad things happening. Maybe it was hearing the woman at the party with the big stuffed thing around her neck say, "Isn't it fabulous—fur is back."

Fur is back. Isn't it fabulous? Mutilation is back. Murder is back. Mink is back. Mink always makes me think about women. Not just that women wear minks, but that there is something about how women are raised to serve. Raised for slaughter. Something about being so beautiful, so soft and warm, that people have to wear

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you, have to wrap you around their neck or rape you or shoot you in the head or mangle or beat or starve you.

Fur is back. Fur is back. Isn't it fabulous, fur is back? So, it turns out, is rape. Rape is back. The Taliban is back. O.J. is back. Fur is back. Back back back.

But when did any of this go away? It never went away. It just gets ignored and buried and accepted by the people at parties, by the people who cannot stop partying, who think that life is one big party, which it is for them because they have everything, because they are wealthy and privileged and perfect and partying partying.

Stop it. Stop it. Please please stop. Women are dying. Women have their labias ripped off in the Congo, their faces melted off in Pakistan, they are bought as children in Atlanta. Stop, please, doesn't it matter to you? Don't their lives matter? I am screaming. I am on the floor, on the wall-to-wall plush carpet near the

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buffet table with its goat cheese quesadillas and grilled shrimp and chocolate martinis. I am on the floor screaming, Stop it, stop it.

Stop. Can't you just stop? For one moment, stop your lives, stop your quest for pleasure, stop your partying. A crowd is now looking at me, a crowd of fabulous partygoers who won't look directly at me 'cause they are scared they might catch what I have, fabulous partygoers going on as I am being handcuffed, dragged, and removed from the party.

I don't move, I can't move. I lie there on the street against the building and I open my eyes. I am looking up, straight up. I don't remember seeing stars before in the city. There are so many of them and they are particularly sparkly. I don't know if they are even real. They are so far away and they are right next to me. I am lying there and my eyes are open. I am not funny and my friend's silk shirt is torn, but I can see what is in

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front of me. I can see the stars.

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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